

Cumulative Final Study Guide

EAM310 · East Asian Medicine Diagnosis I · VUIM Summer 2026

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Full Cumulative · Weeks 1–9, equal depth

TCM for Ballroom Dancers

reMarkable Edition

How to use this guide: Read once per week, cold, to catch gaps — then drill against the Cram Sheet for speed. Every finding-to-pattern mapping lives in a table; memorize rows, not paragraphs. Week 5 is intentionally absent (midterm week, no new content).

1 · Week 1 — Vital Substances

The Vital Substances (Jing, Qi, Blood, Fluids, Shen) are the raw material every later diagnostic system reads for signs of excess, deficiency, stagnation, or heat.

Jīng 精 (Essence)

Type	Source	Nature	Clinical Significance
Pre-Heaven 先天精	Blending of parents' sexual energies before birth	Fixed in quantity/quality, cannot be replenished; stored in Kidney	Nourishes embryo; determines constitutional strength and vitality
Post-Heaven 後天精	Refined food & fluids after birth (Spleen/Stomach)	Can be stored and replenished	Continuously tops up Kidney Essence
Kidney Essence 腎精	Pre-Heaven + Post-Heaven combined	Fixed qty, replenished by Post-Heaven; resides at Míng Mén	Generates Tiān Guǐ (menses/sperm); produces Marrow → Spinal Cord → Brain

Quick Recall: Pre-Heaven = inheritance (fixed). Post-Heaven = income (tops it up). Kidney Essence = the account balance.

Jīng Deficiency — Clinical Signs

Population	Signs
Children	Poor bone development, soft bones; late fontanelle closure; mental dullness; developmental delays
Adults	Softening of bones, weak knees/legs, lower backache, loose teeth; poor memory; tinnitus, deafness, premature greying; infertility

Qì 氣 (Vital Force) — Formation Flow

Name	漢字	Source	Key Function
Congenital Qi	先天氣	Inherited, Kidneys	Determines constitution; cannot be replenished
Air/Clear Qi	清氣	Lung (inhaled)	Respiration
Food/Grain Qi	穀氣	Spleen/Stomach	Origin of Qi & Blood; rises to combine with Air Qi
Gathering Qi	宗氣	Air Qi + Gu Qi, chest	Nourishes Heart/Lung; controls voice; drives circulation
Source/Original Qi	原氣	Kidney Essence, Míng Mén	"Motive force" — arouses/moves all organs
True/Vital Qi	真氣	Zong Qi (final stage)	Splits into Ying Qi & Wei Qi; IS Meridian Qi
Nutritive Qi	營氣	Zhen Qi (Yin aspect)	Nourishes internal organs; linked to Blood; acupuncture Qi
Defensive Qi	衛氣	Zhen Qi (Yang aspect)	Protects from pathogens; controls pores; circulates 50x/24h
Central Qi	中氣	Spleen Qi	Supports transformation/transportation; prevents prolapse

6 Functions of Qi

Function	Clinical Note
Transporting	No movement = pain
Warming	Qi deficiency → Cold signs
Protecting	Wei Qi def → recurrent infections
Holding	Deficiency → incontinence, excessive bleeding/sweating
Transforming	Qi def → Phlegm & Dampness accumulation
Rising	Qi def → sinking → organ prolapse (Spleen)

Qi Pathologies — 4 Patterns

Pattern	Mechanism	Signs & Symptoms	Tongue/Pulse
Qi Deficiency	More Qi consumed than produced (LU, SP, KD, HT)	Fatigue, slight SOB, weak voice, spontaneous sweating, poor appetite, loose stools	Empty pulse; pale/normal tongue
Sinking Qi	Aspect of Qi Def — insufficient Yang to rise (Spleen)	All Qi Def signs + bearing-down feeling, organ prolapse	Empty pulse
Qi Stagnation	Often Liver, also Lung/Heart/Stomach/Spleen	Distension, moving/distending pain (more distension than pain), irritability, sighing	Wiry pulse; normal/slightly red-sided tongue
Rebellious Qi	Qi moves wrong direction (Maciocia Table 31.1)	Stomach ↑ =nausea/belching; Spleen ↓ =diarrhea/prolapse; Lung ↑ =cough/asthma; Heart ↑ =insomnia	Varies by organ

Xuè 血 (Blood)

The most Yin vital substance — a dense material form of Qi. Sū Wèn 26: "Blood is the mind of a person."

Pattern	Signs & Symptoms	Tongue/Pulse
Blood Deficiency	Dull-white sallow complexion, pale lips, dizziness, poor memory, insomnia, scanty periods	Pale, thin, slightly dry tongue; Choppy or Fine pulse
Blood Stasis	Stabbing/fixed/boring pain, dark complexion, purple lips/nails, fixed abdominal masses	Purple tongue (location varies); Wiry, Choppy, or Firm pulse
Heat in Blood	Feeling of heat, skin eruptions, thirst, bleeding	Red tongue; Rapid pulse
Loss of Blood	Bloody nose, vomiting blood, blood in stool/urine, menorrhagia	Pale tongue; Fine/Choppy pulse

Qi Stagnation vs Blood Stasis — Key Differentiator (Maciocia Table 32.2)

	Qi Stagnation	Blood Stasis
Pain vs distension	More distension than pain; moving	More pain than distension; fixed
Pain character	Distending, comes & goes	Boring or stabbing, constant
Abdominal masses	Appear and disappear	Fixed
Tongue	Normal or slightly red on sides	Purple on sides
Pulse	Wiry	Wiry, Firm, or Choppy

Blood Stasis — Signs by Location

Location	Key Signs
Liver	Purple nails, dark face, painful periods with dark clots, wiry/firm pulse
Heart	Purple lips, stabbing chest pain, mental restlessness, distended sub-lingual veins
Lung	Chest oppression, coughing dark blood, tongue purple on sides toward front
Stomach	Epigastric pain, vomiting dark blood, tongue purple in center
Intestines/Uterus	Dark blood in stools, severe abdominal pain, dark menstrual clots, fixed masses

Jīn Yè 津液 (Body Fluids)

	Jīn 津 (Yang)	Yè 液 (Yin)
Character	Clear, light, watery	Turbid, heavy, dense
Circulates with	Wei Qi (Exterior, between skin/muscles)	Ying Qi (Interior)
Movement	Quick	Slow
Controlled by	Lung (Upper Burner)	Spleen & Kidney (Middle/Lower Burner)
Moistens	Skin & muscles (sweat, tears, saliva)	Joints, spine, brain, bone marrow, orifices

Quick Recall: Fluid Deficiency is Yin in nature — deficiency presents as dryness.

2 · Week 2 — Eight Principles 八綱

The Eight Principles are the foundation every other diagnostic system builds on — get Excess/Deficiency wrong and treatment tonifies an Excess pattern, trapping the pathogen inside.

Pair	Characters	Key Differentiator
Yin/Yang	陰陽	Master pair. Yin = Interior+Cold+Deficiency (slower, quieter). Yang = Exterior+Heat+Excess (faster, louder, active).
Exterior/Interior	表里	Exterior = fever + aversion to cold SIMULTANEOUSLY + Floating pulse. The moment aversion to cold disappears, the pathogen has moved Interior (Deep pulse).
Deficiency/Excess	虛實	Pressure response is the ONE key differentiator. Deficiency = pain RELIEVED by pressure/warmth. Excess = pain AGGRAVATED by pressure.
Cold/Heat	寒熱	Full Heat = whole face red, thick yellow coat, strong Rapid pulse. Empty Heat = malar flush only, little/no coating, thin Rapid pulse (degree differentiates the two).

Why 8 Principles come first: every other system (Qi/Blood/Fluids, Zang-Fu, Meridians, Six Meridians, Four Levels, Five Elements) presumes you've already correctly sorted Excess vs. Deficiency and Hot vs. Cold. Errors compound downstream.

3 · Week 3 — Pulse Diagnosis 脈診

Pulse positions follow Nan Jing Difficulty 18 (verified against FCM Ch. 30). Each position reflects a Zang + paired Fu together, never a single organ.

Six Positions

Position	Left Hand	Right Hand
Cùn (superficial)	Heart / Small Intestine	Lung / Large Intestine
Guān (middle)	Liver / Gallbladder	Spleen / Stomach
Chǐ (deep)	Kidney / Bladder	Pericardium / San Jiao

Trap: Right Chǐ is Pericardium/San Jiao specifically, linked to Kidney only via Ming Men theory — NOT Kidney-Yang/Ming Men directly.

Method & Normal Pulse

Concept	Detail
5 finger movements	Lifting (superficial) · Pressing (deep) · Searching (rate) · Pushing (shape) · Rolling (length)
Normal pulse 胃神根	胃 Wèi = flowing/gentle · 神 Shén = strong/rhythmical · 根 Gēn = rooted, deep at Chǐ
Normal rate	4–5 beats per practitioner's breath, 60–90bpm
8 components	Width, Depth, Rate, Rhythm, Strength, Length, Tension, Shape

Seasonal Pulses

Season	Pulse	Dates
Spring	Wiry 弦	Feb 4 – May 4
Summer	Flooding 洪	May 5 – Aug 6
Autumn	Hair-like 毛	Aug 7 – Nov 6
Winter	Stone 石	Nov 7 – Feb 3

Quick Recall: a seasonal pulse is only abnormal when accompanied by symptoms (e.g., Flooding in Winter = warning sign, not a variant).

Core Combinations

Base Quality	+ Second Quality → Pattern
Floating +	Tight=Ext Wind-Cold · Rapid=Ext Wind-Heat · Empty=Summer-Heat or Yin Def · Slippery=Wind-Damp/Phlegm · Weak=External-Empty
Deep +	Slow=Int Cold · Rapid=Int Heat · Weak=Yang Def · Wiry=Blood Stasis/Chong Mai · Soggy-Slow=Int Dampness
Slow +	Weak=Empty-Cold/Yang Def · Full=Full Cold (chronic pain) · Choppy=Blood Def+Int Cold · Slippery=Cold-Phlegm · Wiry=Cold in Liver channel
Rapid +	Full=Full Heat · Empty=Empty Heat (Yin Def) · Wiry=Liver Fire · Slippery=Phlegm-Heat · Overflowing=Full Heat

The Traps

Trap	Detail
Floating ≠ always Exterior	Also Yin Deficiency — Yin fails to anchor Yang. Presents Floating+Thin+Rapid, night sweats, five-palm heat, malar flush, dry throat worse at night. True Exterior floating has SIMULTANEOUS aversion to cold + fever.
Huǎn is the healthy one	Slowed-Down/Moderate 緩 = 4 beats/breath, faster than Slow = the only qualitatively normal entry among the 28. Easy to misread as Slow.
Irregular rhythm 3-way split	Knotted 結 = SLOW+random stops → Cold w/ Heart-Yang Def. Hasty 促 = RAPID+random stops → Severe Heat/Heart-Fire. Intermittent 代 = pauses at REGULAR intervals → most serious, internal organ/Heart problem.

All 28 Pulse Qualities

#	Quality	Tactile Image	Indication
1	Floating 浮	A subtle breeze across a bird's back	Invasion of external Wind; Yin Deficiency presenting superficially
2	Deep/Submerged 沉	A stone sinking to the bottom of a well	Pathogenic factor in the Interior; Yang Deficiency (Deep-Weak)
3	Slow 遲	Fewer than 3 beats/breath, ~40–60bpm	Cold pattern (Empty-Cold if Weak, Full-Cold if Full)
4	Rapid 數	Over 5 beats/breath, 90–140bpm	Heat pattern (Full-Heat if Full, Empty-Heat if Floating-Empty)
5	Empty/Deficient 虛	A water balloon — big outside, nothing solid on pressure	Qi Deficiency
6	Full/Excessive 實	Felt at all 3 positions and all 3 depths	Full pattern
7	Slippery 滑	A pearl rolling on a plate	Phlegm, Dampness, food retention, pregnancy
8	Choppy 澀	Scraping bamboo with a small knife	Blood Deficiency; exhaustion of Body Fluids
9	Long 長	Smooth and straight	Heat patterns
10	Short 短	Cannot be felt in all 3 positions	Severe Qi Deficiency; Stomach-Qi Deficiency
11	Overflowing 洪	Ocean waves — come strongly, leave calmly	Full-Heat (Overflowing-Empty = Empty-Heat)
12	Fine/Thin 細	Angel-hair pasta, not thick udon	Blood Deficiency; Dampness with severe Qi Def
13	Minute/Faint 微	Now you see it, now you don't	Severe deficiency of Qi and Blood
14	Tight 緊	A twisted cord snapping back and forth	Cold (Ext, Int Full, or Int Empty by depth); Pain
15	Wiry 弦	A guitar string about to snap	Liver disharmony; Pain; Phlegm
16	Slowed/Moderate 緩	4 beats/breath — faster than Slow	Generally a HEALTHY pulse — the one normal entry
17	Hollow 芤	A scallion stalk — edge but hollow inside	Hemorrhage; forthcoming hemorrhage if Rapid; Yin Def
18	Leather 革	A drum surface — thick on top, hollow beneath	Severe Kidney-Essence/Kidney-Yin Deficiency
19	Firm/Confined 牢	—	Blood Stasis; Interior Cold (if Slow); Pain
20	Soggy 濡	—	Dampness with Qi Deficiency; Yin/Essence Deficiency
21	Weak/Frail 弱	—	Yang Deficiency; Blood Deficiency
22	Scattered 散	—	Severe Qi and Blood Deficiency; serious condition
23	Hidden 伏	—	Severe Yang Deficiency
24	Moving 動	—	Shock, anxiety, fright; Pain
25	Hasty 促	Rapid + random stops	Severe Heat; Heart-Qi Deficiency; Heart-Fire
26	Knotted 結	Slow + random stops	Cold with Heart-Yang Deficiency
27	Intermittent 代	Pauses at regular intervals	Serious internal organ / Heart problem
28	Hurried/Racing 疾	—	Fire exhausting Yin

4 • Week 4 — Tongue Diagnosis 舌診

Observation is based on four main aspects, plus Spirit. The coating reflects Wei Qi; the body reflects Ying Qi; the sublingual veins reflect Yuan Qi.

Aspect	Reflects
Body color	Blood/Nutritive Qi; Heat/Cold and Yin/Yang of the Yin organs
Body shape	State of Blood/Nutritive Qi; moisture
Coating	State of the Yang organs; Heat/Cold; Fullness/Deficiency
Moisture	State of the Body Fluids
Spirit	General appearance, color, and state of the tongue body

Tongue Body Color

Color	Variant	Indication
Pale	Swollen + fluid on it	Yang Deficiency
Pale	Small, thin, little fluid	Blood Deficiency
Pale	Sides only	Liver Blood Deficiency
Pale	Center section only	Spleen Blood Deficiency
Red	With coating	Full-Heat
Red	Without coating	Empty-Heat
Red	Tip only	Heart-Fire (w/ coating) or Heart Empty-Heat (w/o)
Red	Sides w/ coating	Liver Fire or Gall Bladder Full Heat
Red	Sides w/o coating	Liver Yin Deficiency with Empty-Heat
Purple	Reddish-purple	Blood stasis from Heat
Purple	Bluish-purple	Blood stasis from Cold
Purple	Center	Blood stasis in the Stomach
Blue	Same category as Bluish-Purple	Interior Cold giving rise to stasis of Blood

Heads up: Purple always indicates Blood stasis regardless of shade — the shade (reddish vs bluish) tells you whether the underlying cause is Heat or Cold.

Common Tongues — Quick Overview

Presentation	Pattern
Slightly pale	Qi Deficiency
Slightly pale and dry	Blood Deficiency
Pale on sides	Liver Blood Deficiency
Pale and slightly wet	Yang Deficiency
Teethmarks / swollen center	Spleen Qi Deficiency
Rootless coating	Stomach Qi/Yin Deficiency
Lack of coating (general)	Yin Deficiency
Lack of coating in center	Stomach Yin Deficiency
Lack of coating front third	Lung Yin Deficiency
Lack of coating all over, red body	Kidney Yin Deficiency

5 • Week 6 — Diagnosis by Observation 望診

Method	Uses
Inspection	Eyes: vitality, color, appearance, secretions (incl. tongue)
Auscultation/Olfaction	Ears (listen) + nose (smell)
Inquiry	Verbal questioning
Palpation	Touch, incl. pulse

Quick Recall: Zang-Xiang = what's inside shows on the outside.

Shen (Vitality)

Observation	Having Shen	Loss of Shen	False Shen
Complexion	Bright and moist	Dim, dull sheen	Dull, then suddenly lustrous
Eyes	Alert, vivid, twinkle	Dull, blurred vision	Dull, then suddenly bright
Mind/Speech	Clear speech, agile	Unconscious, delirious	Unclear, then sudden change
Motion/Response	Quick, appropriate	Sluggish, slow	Suddenly responsive
Respiration	Even	Rapid, feeble, or difficult	Feeble, then briefly steady

Heads up: False Shen is a sudden brightening in a critical patient — a warning sign, NOT recovery.

Deranged Shen (Shén Luàn)

Presentation	Description
Fán zào	Irritability + hot/feverish sensation
Zàng zào	Depression, hallucination, crying spells, no loss of consciousness
Bái hé bìng	Chronic depression, mumbling, insomnia, sleepwalking
Diǎn (Yin madness)	Chronic depression, mumbling, inappropriate laugh/cry
Kuáng (Yang madness)	Raving, aggression, wandering naked, obscenities

Su Wen 32 — Face Heat Map

Region (patient's own left/right)	Organ
L cheek (patient's)	Liver
Forehead	Heart
Nose	Spleen
R cheek (patient's)	Lung
Chin	Kidney

Quick Recall: face-forward pictures mirror this — the patient's left is on YOUR right.

Five Colors of Face

Color	Indication
Red	Heat (excess=whole face; malar only=Yin-def heat)
Pale/White	Cold, blood/yang deficiency (puffy=yang qi def; withered=blood def)
Yellow	Deficiency, damp (bright=yang jaundice/damp-heat; smoky=yin jaundice)
Blue-Green	Cold, pain, stagnation, convulsion
Dark Grey/Black	Kidney deficiency, blood stasis

Quick Recall: lustrous complexion = good prognosis; dark/haggard = poor prognosis.

Body Shape & Movement

Finding	Pattern
Overweight + depression	Qi deficiency + excess phlegm-damp
Thin, dry skin	Blood insufficiency
Great weight loss, long illness	Exhaustion of essential Qi
Overweight overall	Yang deficiency with phlegm
Thin overall	Yin deficiency
Active movement	Yang syndrome
Passive manner	Yin syndrome
Violent limb movement	Wind disease (tetanus, infantile convulsion)
Muscle weakness/atrophy	Wei syndrome
Pain+swelling+restricted joints	Bi syndrome (painful obstruction)

Five Wheels of the Eye

Wheel	Structure	Organ
Blood	Inner/outer canthus	Heart
Qi	Sclera	Lung
Wind	Iris	Liver
Water	Pupil	Kidney
Flesh	Eyelids (upper=Spleen, lower=Stomach)	Spleen/Stomach

6 · Week 7 — Diagnosis by Inquiry 問診

Topic	Detail
10 vs 16 Questions	Maciocia's 10: chills/fever, sweating, head/body, 2 excretions, diet, chest/abdomen, hearing, thirst/drink, previous illness, cause. Schrier's 16 adds Pain, Emotions, Sexual Symptoms, Energy Level.
16 in order	1 Pain · 2 Food/Taste · 3 Stools/Urine · 4 Thirst/Drink · 5 Energy · 6 Head/Face/Body · 7 Chest/Abdomen · 8 Limbs · 9 Sleep · 10 Sweating · 11 Ears/Eyes · 12 Cold/Heat/Fever · 13 Emotional · 14 Sexual · 15 Women's · 16 Children's
Golden Rule	Every question should confirm or exclude a pattern — never recite the 16 as a rote script; always ask why.

Q1 — Pain

Topic	Detail
3 mechanisms (Neijing)	Circulation impeded (Su Wen 39) · Tension (Su Wen 39/62, Ling Shu 10) · Lack of nourishment
Full vs Empty pain	Full: aggravated by food/BM/vomiting/pressure, relieved by rest, sharp, worse w/ movement. Empty: alleviated by food/BM/rest/pressure, dull, better w/ movement.
Pain character	Distending/moving=Qi stagnation · boring/stabbing fixed=Blood stasis · cramping+cold=Cold · burning+fullness=Heat · intense+fullness=food retention
Bi Syndrome (5 types)	Wandering=Wind · Painful=Cold · Fixed=Damp · Heat=Heat (sudden, swelling/redness) · Bone=chronic progression of the other 4

Q2–4 — Food, Taste, Stools, Urine, Thirst

Topic	Mapping
Appetite	Lack=SP–Qi def · excessive=ST–Heat · fullness=Dampness/food retention · distention=Qi stagnation
Taste	Bitter=Liver/Heart Heat · sweet=SP def or Damp–Heat · sour=food retention or LR invading ST · salty=KD–Yin def · pungent=LU–Heat
Stools	Better after BM=Full · worse after BM=Empty · undigested food=SP–Qi def · black/dark=Blood stasis · alternating constip/diarrhea=stagnant LR–Qi invading SP
Urine color	Pale=Cold · dark=Heat · turbid/cloudy=Dampness
Urine pain timing	Before=Qi stagnation Lower Burner · during=Damp–Heat Bladder · after=Qi deficiency
Thirst	Cold drinks desired=Heat · warm drinks desired=Cold · no thirst=Cold/no Heat · thirst but no desire to drink=Damp–Heat or Yin def

Q5, Q9, Q10 — Energy, Sleep, Sweating

Topic	Mapping
Tiredness	AM worse=SP/ST–Yang def · weak voice=LU–Qi/Yang def · feeling cold=KD–Yang def · heaviness=Dampness · dizzy+nausea=Phlegm · distention+irritable+Wiry=LR–Qi stagnation
Sleep physiology	Depends on Blood/Yin of Heart & Liver; Spleen also influences. Shen and Hun need anchoring by HT/LR Blood.
Insomnia types	Can't fall/stay asleep=Blood def not anchoring Shen/Hun (Empty). Restless+heat+dreaming=pathogens agitating Shen/Hun out of Blood (Full). Wake many times=Yin def w/ Empty Heat. Wake early=GB deficiency.
Sweat location	Head only=ST Heat/Damp–Heat · whole body=LU–Qi def · palms/soles/chest=Yin def (5–palm heat) · day=Yang def · night=Yin def

Not tested: Categories of Dreams / Neijing dream chapters (Su Wen 17, 80; Ling Shu 43) are explicitly marked not tested.

Q6 — Head, Face, Body

Headache Location	Channel	Cause
Nape	Tai Yang	Ext. Wind–Cold or Kidney def
Forehead	Yang Ming	Stomach–Heat or Blood def
Temples/sides	Shao Yang	Ext. Wind or Liver/GB Fire rising
Vertex	Jue Yin	Liver–Blood deficiency
Whole head	—	Ext. Wind–Cold

Headache Timing/ Quality	Indication
Daytime	Qi/Yang deficiency
Evening	Blood/Yin deficiency
Night	Blood stasis
Heavy quality	Damp/Phlegm
Distending/throbbing	Liver-Yang rising
Boring/nail-like	Blood stasis
Numbness: bilateral vs unilateral	Bilateral=Blood deficiency; Unilateral (esp. first 3 fingers)=Internal Wind + Phlegm, possible impending Wind-stroke

7 · Week 8 — Diagnosis by Palpation 切診 (non-pulse)

Topic	Detail
3 Techniques	Palpation (tracing, hands/feet→elbows/knees) · Pressing (thumb/fingertip, 3x increasing pressure) · Feeling (temperature/moisture/texture)
Pressing logic	Tenderness/pain=Excess · more pain=accumulated Xie Qi · weak/soft ± tenderness=Qi stagnation · slippery/hard=Phlegm

Skin Temperature

Presentation	Pattern
Cold	Cold pattern
Hot on 1st touch, cools w/ pressure	Exterior Wind-Heat
Hot on medium (not heavy) pressure	Interior Heat (Middle Burner/Heart)
Hot on heavy pressure near bone	Empty-Heat from Yin deficiency
Hot on dorsal (back of hand)	Full Heat (Ling Shu 74)
Hot on palm	Empty Heat (Ling Shu 74)

Xu Li (Apical Beat)

Presentation	Pattern
Clear/slow	Normal
Feeble	Zong Qi deficiency
Strong/hard	Excess Lung/Heart
Large but empty	Heart-Qi deficiency
Stop-start	Shock, poor prognosis
Rapid	Shock, fright, anger

Abdominal & Point Palpation

Topic	Detail
Nan Jing 5-Phase map	Above navel (Ren 12–15)=Heart/Fire · at navel=Spleen/Earth · below navel (Ren 7–Pubis)=Kidney/Water · R side under ribs=Lung/Metal · L side under ribs=Liver/Wood. Cite Nan Jing/Shang Han Lun, not Su Wen.
Normal abdomen	Solid-not-hard, resilient-not-tight, elastic-not-soft. Hard+pain worse w/ pressure=Full. Too-soft+ache relieved=Empty. Soft/flabby lower abdomen=Yuan Qi def. Fixed masses=Blood stasis.
Front-Mu vs Back-Shu	Front-Mu = front/Yin surface, sensitive as Qi collects/accumulates. Back-Shu = on Bladder channel, roughly level with the organ, strong for tonify/sedate.

Quick Recall: Fuku Shin key figures — Sugiyama (1610–94), Todo Yoshimasu (1702–73), Inaba Bunrei & Yoshitora Wakuda (19th c.).

8 · Week 9 — Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling 聞診

Wén Zhén is the second of the Four Diagnostic Methods (望聞問切) and has two distinct components sharing one character (聞 — "to perceive with the ear/nose").

Component	Covers
Hearing	Voice, breathing, cough, vomiting, hiccup, borborygmi, sighing, belching — any sound emitted by the patient
Smelling	Body odor, and odor of bodily secretions (breath, sweat, sputum, urine/stools, vaginal discharge, intestinal gas)

Voice & Zang-Fu Relationship

Organ	Role	Governs
Lung	Gateway of the voice; movement of Qi helps create sounds	Production of sound
Kidney	Root of the voice; root of Yuan Qi	Volume of the voice
Spleen/Stomach	Acquired root of Qi	Strength of the voice

Voice, Breathing & Reflexive Sound Patterns

Presentation	Pattern
Loud voice	Full or Heat pattern
Weak voice	Empty or Cold pattern
Reluctance to talk	Cold pattern or Lung-Qi deficiency
Excessive talking	Heat
Sudden loss of voice	Invasion of Wind-Heat
Gradual loss of voice	Lung-Qi or Lung-Yin deficiency
Coarse, loud breathing	Full pattern
Weak, thin breathing	Empty pattern
Deep breathing	Excess Qi in Heart and Lungs
Weak breathing	Deficiency of Qi in Liver and Kidney
Loud, explosive cough	Full pattern
Weak cough	Empty pattern
Vomiting, slow, weak sound	Deficiency/Cold (often Stomach def & Cold)
Vomiting, sudden, loud, forceful	Excess/Heat (often Stomach-Heat)
Belching, loud and long	Full — food retention, Stomach-Heat, or Liver-Qi invading Stomach
Belching, short and low	Deficiency — Stomach-Qi deficiency or with Cold
Borborygmi, loud	Full pattern (often w/ diarrhea/dysentery)
Borborygmi, low	Empty pattern (Spleen/Kidney Yang deficiency)
Sighing	Qi stagnation of the Liver or Lungs, often from emotional causes

Five Element Sounds & Six Healing Sounds

Sound	Element
Shouting	Wood
Laughing	Fire
Singing	Earth
Weeping	Metal
Groaning	Water

Quick Recall: the Six Healing Sounds (Xu, He, Hu, Si, Chui, Xi) are a therapeutic application of this same Five-Element/San-Jiao framework, each targeting a specific organ.

Diagnosis by Smelling

Odor	Description / Indication
Rancid/Sour	Fat no longer fresh; also smell of newly-mown grass; prickling effect on the nose
Scorched	Burnt toast, clothes from the dryer, a scorched shirt while ironing
Fragrant	Related to pleasant smells like flowers, but not as pleasing — cloying, sickly sweet, tends to linger
Rotten	Rotting meat; fills the nose with tiny prickles
Putrid	Similar to rotting meat but sharper/more aggressive; smell of stagnant water

Secretion	Finding	Pattern
Breath	Strong, foul	Stomach Heat or retention of food
Breath	Sour	Retention of food, Accumulation Disorder
Breath	Foul, pungent	Damp Heat in Stomach
Sweat	Putrid-smelling	Damp-Heat
Sputum	Strong-smelling, rotten	Phlegm-Heat or Toxic Heat
Sputum	Fishy-smelling	Lung-Heat
Urine	Heavy smell of urea, scanty yellow	Heart fire pouring into Bladder
Urine	Clear, frequent, odorless	Cold
Vaginal discharge	Strong-smelling, leathery	Damp-Heat
Vaginal discharge	Fishy smell	Damp-Cold

Flag: the Scorched odor slide uses 笑 (xiào) where the classical character is 焦 (jiāo) — confirm with Prof. Schrier before the final. The Five Named Odors are not explicitly paired to Zang-Fu organs in the source slides.